Keyboard Autoclicker – Installation Guide

Keyboard Autoclicker presses or holds keys on your keyboard automatically, like OP Auto Clicker does with the mouse. This guide takes you from the downloaded ZIP file to a working program, step by step.

How long does it take? About 15 minutes the first time. After that you start the program like any other app, without a terminal window.

> **About the pictures:** The pictures in this guide are schematic illustrations, not real screenshots. Your windows may look slightly different (for example other version numbers or a different Windows theme), but every button, box and text mentioned in the steps is the one you will see.

What you will do

1. Unpack the ZIP file.
2. Install Python (needed once, to build the program).
3. Optional: install Inno Setup (needed once, only if you want a real installer).
4. Double-click `build_exe.bat` to build the program.
5. Install the program (or just run it).
6. Start it and press **F6**.

Before you start

- Windows 10 or Windows 11 (64-bit).
- An internet connection for the first build (about 20 MB are downloaded).
- About 500 MB of free disk space for the build. The finished program is much smaller.
- You do not need administrator rights to build. The installer asks for them only if you choose to install for all users.

Step 1 – Unpack the files

1. Find the file **KeyboardAutoclicker_Build.zip** (usually in your **Downloads** folder).
2. Right-click it and choose **Extract All…**, then click **Extract**.
3. Open the new folder **KeyboardAutoclicker_Build**.

Do not start anything from inside the ZIP file. Windows shows ZIP content like a folder, but the files must be extracted first.

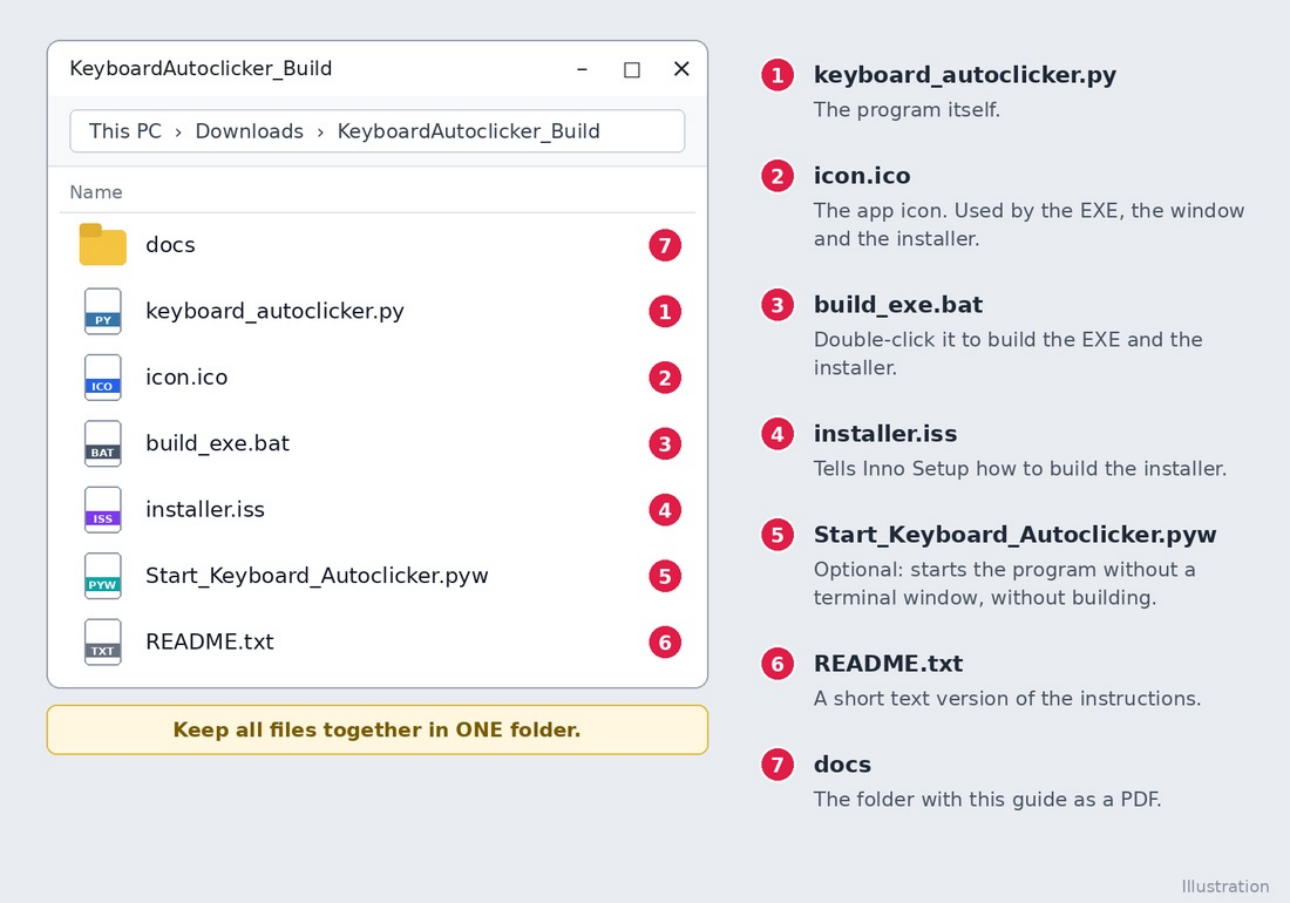


Figure 1 – The files in the extracted folder

Check: You see the six files from Figure 1 and the folder `docs` (it holds this guide as a PDF), all in the same folder. If one of the six files is missing, the build in Step 4 stops with an error that names the missing file.

Step 2 – Install Python

Python is the programming language the program is written in. You need it once to build the program.

1. Open **https://www.python.org/downloads/** in your browser.
2. Click the yellow button **Download Python 3.x.x** and open the downloaded file.
3. In the first window of the setup, tick **Add python.exe to PATH** (see Figure 2). This is the most important step. Without it, the build cannot find Python.
4. Click **Install Now** and wait until the setup says **Setup was successful**. Click **Close**.

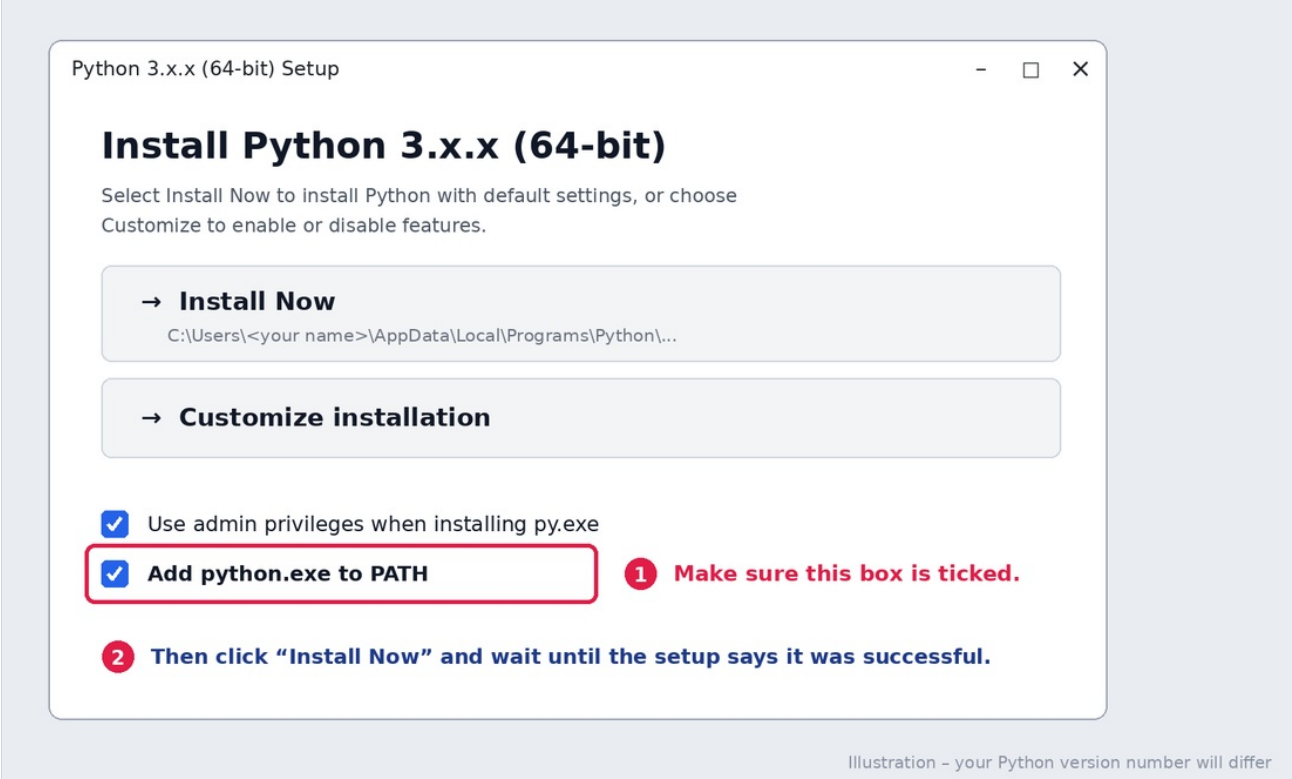


Figure 2 – The first window of the Python setup

Check (optional): Press the **Windows key**, type `cmd` and press **Enter**. In the black window type `python --version` and press **Enter**. It should answer with `Python 3.` followed by numbers. If Windows opens the Microsoft Store instead, Python is not on the PATH: run the Python setup again and tick **Add python.exe to PATH**.

Step 3 – Optional: install Inno Setup

Inno Setup turns your program into a classic installer (`KeyboardAutoclicker_Setup.exe`). If you only want the program itself, skip this step. You can come back later and run Step 4 again.

1. Open **https://jrsoftware.org/isdl.php** and download the latest **Inno Setup 6** installer (a file like `innosetup-6.x.x.exe`).
2. Run it and accept the license agreement. Keep all default options, including **Install Inno Setup Preprocessor** if it is offered, and click **Next** until the installation is finished.

The Inno Setup window shows the note “Non-commercial use only”. That is fine for private use. Please read the Inno Setup license if you want to use it commercially.

Step 4 – Build the program

1. In the folder **KeyboardAutoclicker_Build**, double-click **build_exe.bat**.
2. If Windows shows **Windows protected your PC**, click **More info** and then **Run anyway**. The file is a plain text script that you can open in Notepad to read.
3. A black window opens and shows three steps. Wait until it says **FINISHED!** and then press any key. This takes about 2 to 5 minutes. Do not close the window while it works.

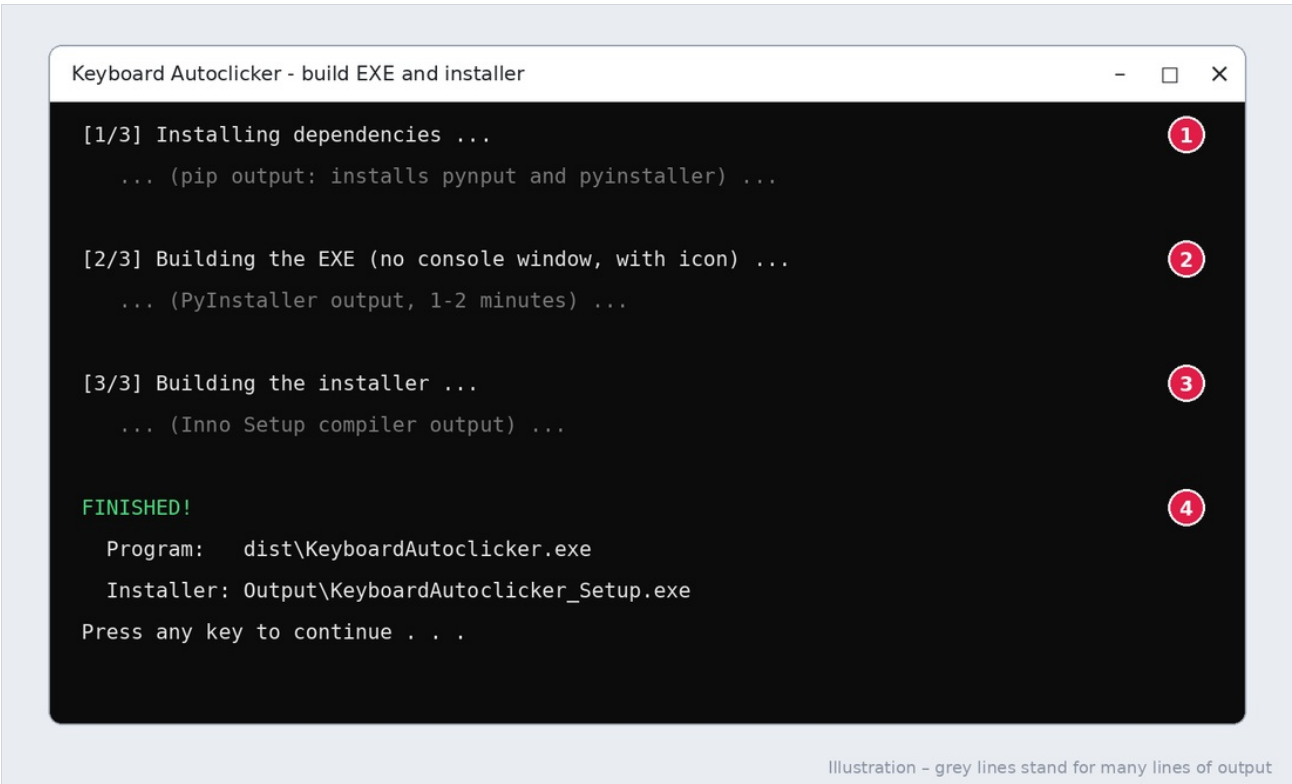


Figure 3 – The build window

What the numbers in Figure 3 mean:

1. **Step 1/3** installs the helper packages pynput and PyInstaller. It needs the internet.
2. **Step 2/3** builds the program `dist\KeyboardAutoclicker.exe`. This is the slowest step.
3. **Step 3/3** builds the installer. It only works if Inno Setup 6 is installed. If it is not, the window tells you so and you still get the program from step 2.
4. **FINISHED!** means success and shows where your files are.

When the build is done, the folder contains the new folders `dist` and `Output` (Figure 4).

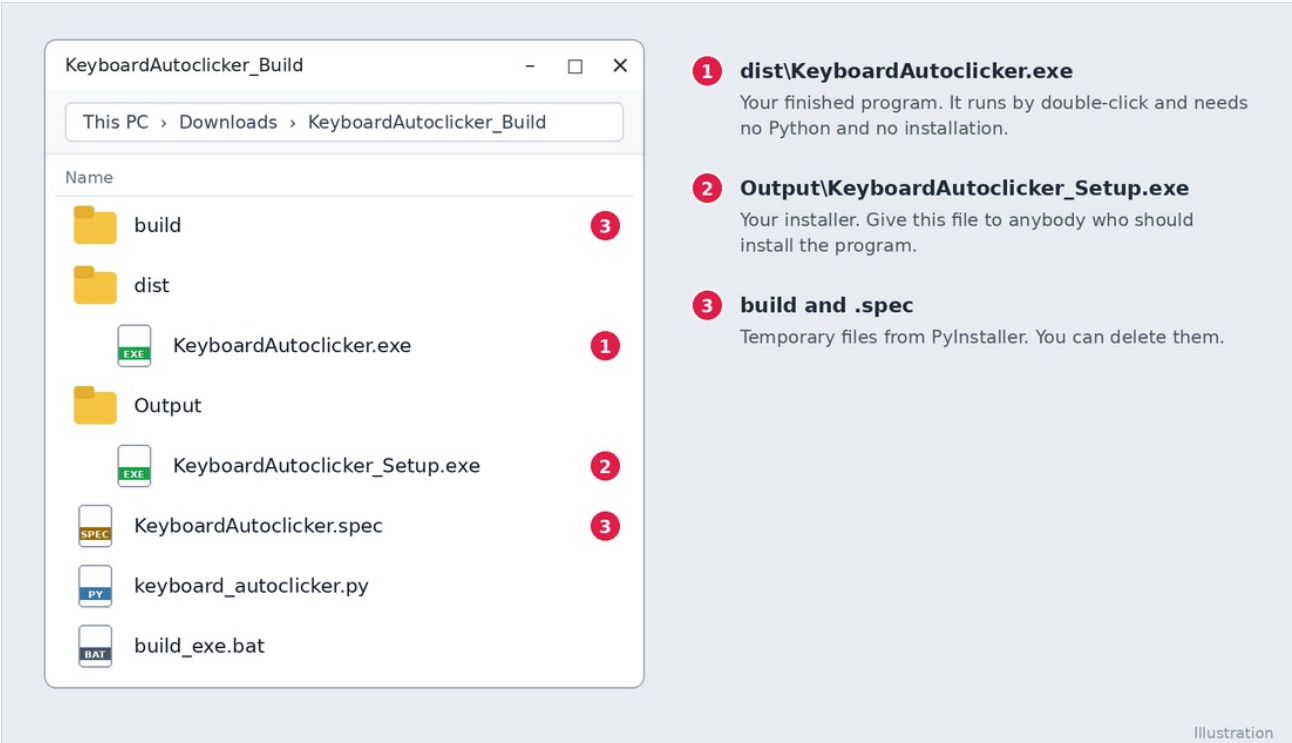


Figure 4 – The folder after a successful build

- `dist\KeyboardAutoclicker.exe` is your finished program. It runs by double-click and needs no installation.
- `Output\KeyboardAutoclicker_Setup.exe` is your installer.
- `build` and `KeyboardAutoclicker.spec` are temporary files. You can delete them.

Step 5 – Install and start the program

Choose one of the three ways.

Option A – With the installer (recommended)

1. Double-click **Output\KeyboardAutoclicker_Setup.exe**. If Windows shows **Windows protected your PC**, click **More info** and **Run anyway**.
2. Choose **Install for all users (recommended)** or **Install for me only**. For all users, Windows asks for administrator permission: click **Yes**.
3. Keep the suggested folder and click **Next**.
4. On the page **Select Additional Tasks** (Figure 5) you can tick **Create a desktop shortcut** (1) and **Start with Windows (minimized)** (2). Click **Next**.
5. Click **Install**, then **Finish**. Leave **Launch Keyboard Autoclicker** ticked to start the program right away.

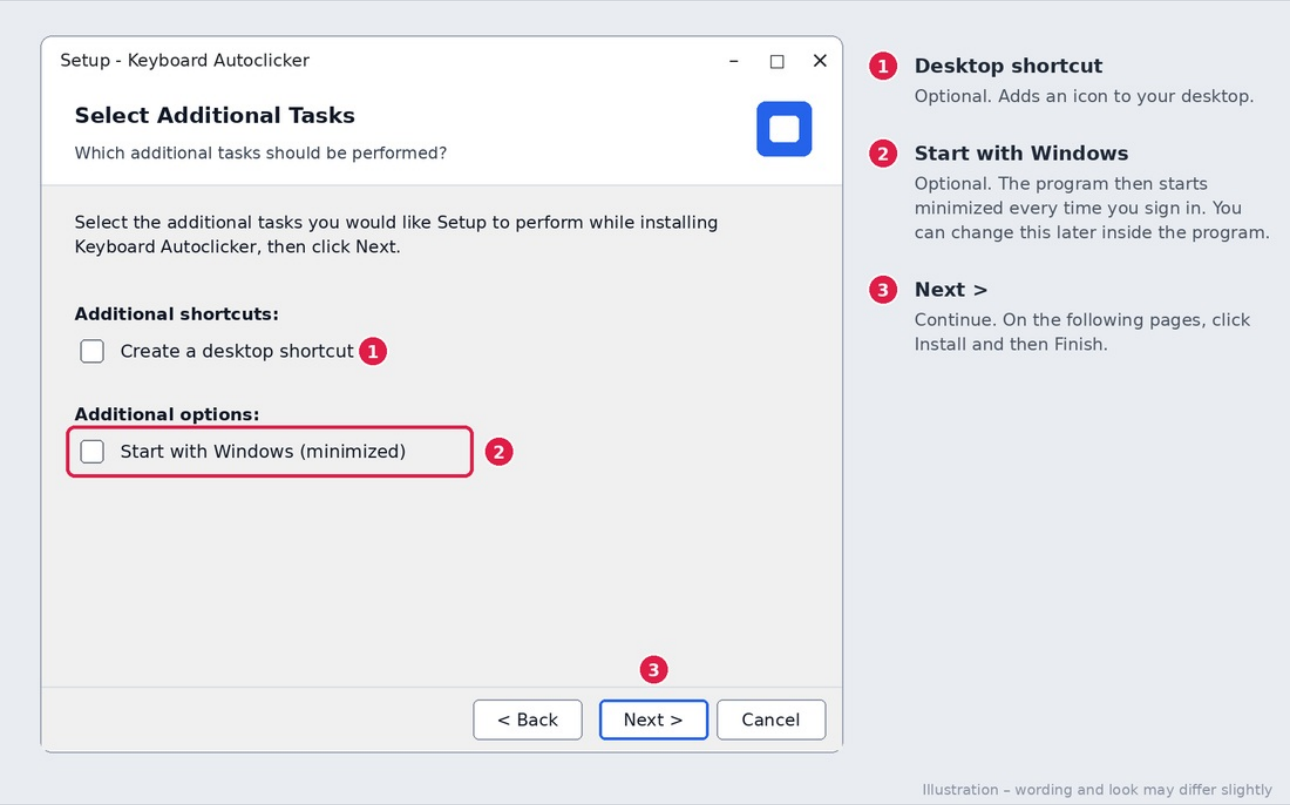


Figure 5 – The page “Select Additional Tasks” of the installer

You will find the program in the Start menu under **Keyboard Autoclicker**.

Option B – Without installing (portable)

Copy **dist\KeyboardAutoclicker.exe** to any folder, for example your desktop, and double-click it. Nothing is installed. You can delete the file to remove the program.

Option C – Without building (still no terminal window)

If you do not want to build anything:

1. Install Python as in Step 2.
2. Press the **Windows key**, type `cmd`, press **Enter**, type `pip install pynput` and press **Enter**. This is needed only once.

3. Double-click **Start_Keyboard_Autoclicker.pyw** in the extracted folder. The program opens without a terminal window.

Step 6 – Use the program

The window has these parts (Figure 6):

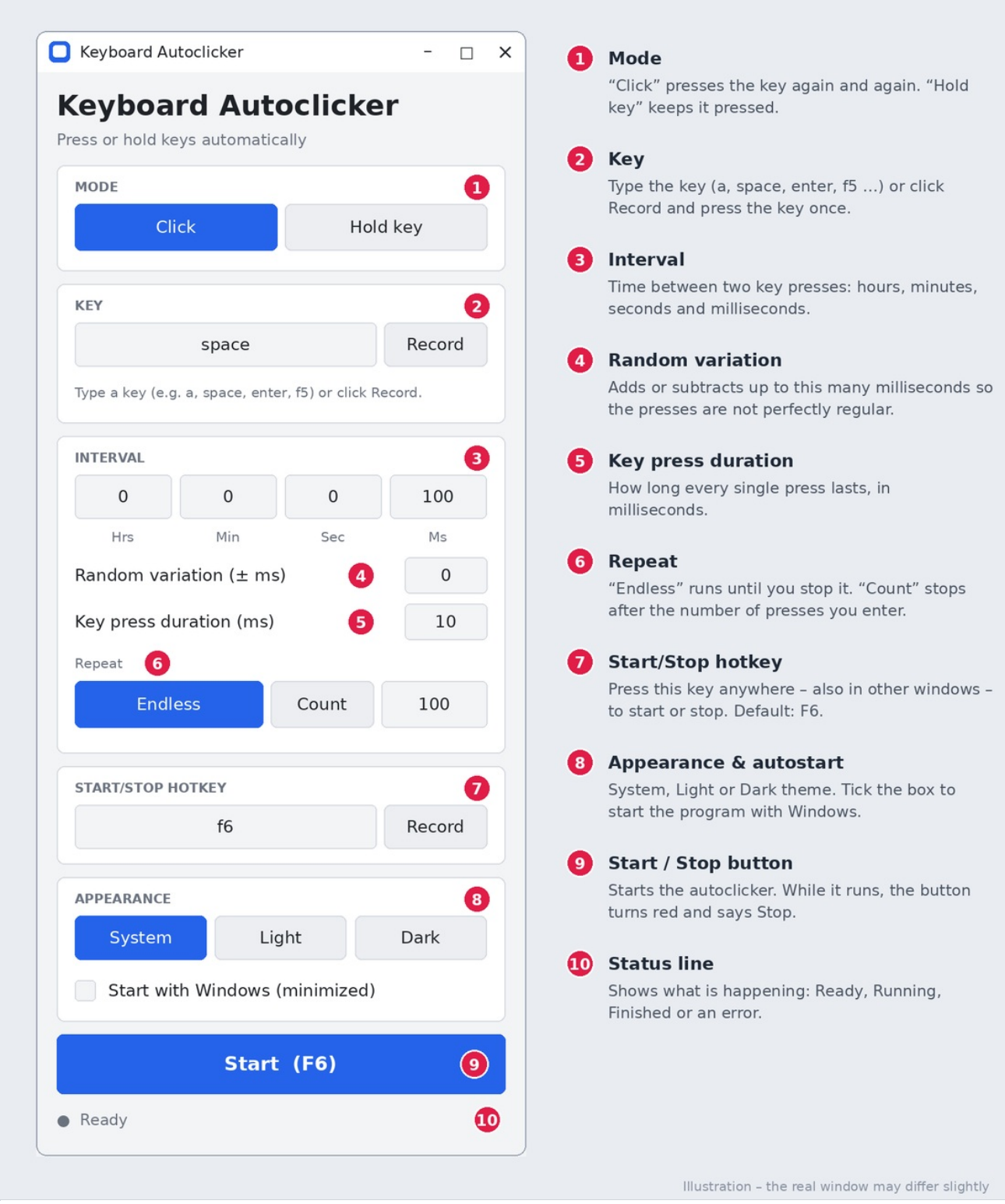


Figure 6 – The program in Click mode (light theme)

1. **Mode** – **Click** presses the key again and again. **Hold key** keeps it pressed.
2. **Key** – Type the key (for example `a`, `space`, `enter`, `f5`) or click **Record** and press the key once.
3. **Interval** – The time between two key presses, in hours, minutes, seconds and milliseconds. 1000 ms are one

second.

4. **Random variation** – Adds or subtracts up to this many milliseconds so that the presses are not perfectly regular. 0 means exact timing.
5. **Key press duration** – How long each press lasts, in milliseconds.
6. **Repeat** – **Endless** runs until you stop it. **Count** stops after the number of presses you type in.
7. **Start/Stop hotkey** – A key that starts and stops the program from anywhere, also while another window is active. The default is **F6**.
8. **Appearance** – **System**, **Light** or **Dark**. The checkbox **Start with Windows (minimized)** starts the program at every sign-in.
9. **Start button** – While the program runs, the button is red and says **Stop**.
10. **Status line** – Shows what is happening: Ready, Running, Finished or an error.

The best way to start: use the hotkey

When you click **Start** with the mouse, the autoclicker window is the active window, so the key presses go there and not into your game or document. Do it like this instead:

1. Set up the key and the timing in the program.
2. Click into the window where the key should be pressed.
3. Press the hotkey **F6**.
4. Press **F6** again to stop.

While the program runs, the input fields are locked. They unlock again when you stop.

Examples

Press Space every 100 milliseconds until you stop: Mode **Click**, Key `space`, Interval **Ms** = 100, Repeat **Endless**. Click into the target window and press **F6**.

Press E fifty times, once per second: Mode **Click**, Key `e`, Interval **Sec** = 1 and **Ms** = 0, Repeat **Count** = 50. The program stops by itself and shows **Finished (50×)**.

Hold W for ten seconds: Mode **Hold key**, Key `w`, **Release after** = 10. Click into the game and press **F6**. The key is released by itself after ten seconds.

Hold key mode

In **Hold key** mode the key is pressed once and then stays down until you stop it (Figure 7).

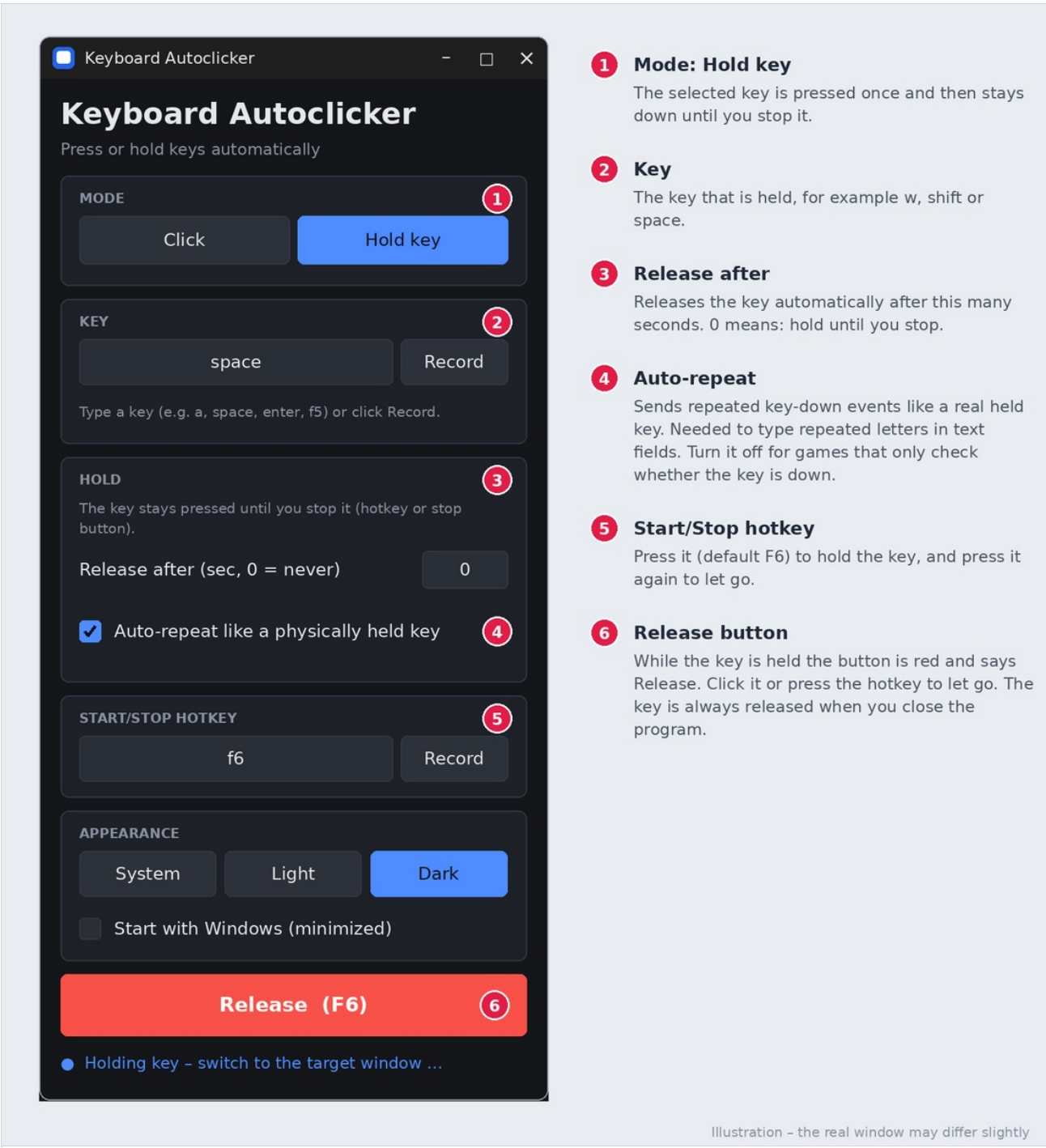


Figure 7 – The program in Hold key mode (dark theme, while the key is held)

1. **Mode: Hold key** – Selects the hold mode.
2. **Key** – The key that is held.
3. **Release after** – The key is released after this many seconds. 0 means: hold until you stop.
4. **Auto-repeat** – Sends repeated key-down signals like a real held key. Leave it on if you want repeated letters in a text field. Turn it off for games that only check whether the key is down.
5. **Start/Stop hotkey** – Press it to hold the key, press it again to let go.
6. **Release button** – The red button says **Release** while the key is held.

The program always releases the key again, also when you close the window or when it ends unexpectedly, so a key cannot get stuck.

Start with Windows (autostart)

Tick **Start with Windows (minimized)** in the program, or choose the same option in the installer. From then on the program starts minimized when you sign in to Windows. You find it in the taskbar. Untick the box to switch it off again. You can also use **Task Manager → Startup apps**.

Your settings (key, timing, hotkey, theme) are saved automatically in `%APPDATA%\KeyboardAutoclicker\settings.json`. To open that folder, press **Windows key + R**, type `%APPDATA%\KeyboardAutoclicker` and press **Enter**.

Uninstall

- **Installed with the installer:** Open **Settings → Apps → Installed apps** (Windows 10: **Apps & features**), choose **Keyboard Autoclicker** and click **Uninstall**. The Start menu also has an **Uninstall Keyboard Autoclicker** entry. The autostart entry is removed as well.
- **Portable (Option B or C):** Delete the program file or folder. If you want, delete the settings folder `%APPDATA%\KeyboardAutoclicker`. If you had ticked autostart, untick it first.

Troubleshooting

Problem	Cause	Solution
Windows opens the Microsoft Store when you type `python`, or `build_exe.bat` says **Python was not found**	Python is not on the PATH	Run the Python setup again and tick **Add python.exe to PATH**. Then run `build_exe.bat` again.
`build_exe.bat` says **icon.ico** or **keyboard_autoclicker.py** is not in the same folder	The ZIP was not extracted, or files were moved	Extract the whole ZIP and keep all files together (Figure 1).
The Inno Setup compiler says **Source file … dist\KeyboardAutoclicker.exe does not exist**	The program has not been built yet	Run `build_exe.bat` first. It creates the folder `dist`. It also builds the installer, so you do not need to open `installer.iss` yourself.
Step 1/3 fails with a network or pip error	No internet, proxy or firewall	Connect to the internet and run `build_exe.bat` again.
Windows SmartScreen or your antivirus warns about the EXE, or removes it	The EXE is not digitally signed. Programs that send keystrokes and single-file Python programs are often flagged by mistake.	Click **More info → Run anyway**, or add an exception for the folder. If you prefer not to use an EXE, use Option C.
The hotkey or the key presses do nothing in a certain program	That program runs as administrator. Windows does not let a normal program send keys to it.	Right-click **Keyboard Autoclicker** and choose **Run as administrator**.
Nothing happens in a game	Some games, especially with anti-cheat, ignore or block simulated keys.	This cannot be fixed. Do not use autoclickers in online games: it can break the rules and lead to a ban.
The message **The program is already running** appears	Another copy is already open, maybe minimized	Look in the taskbar and close or open the existing copy.
The program shows the old icon after a rebuild	Windows remembers old icons	Restart Windows Explorer or sign out and in again.
A key seems stuck	The program was stopped in the middle of a press	Close the program (it releases all keys) or press the key once.

Appendix – key names

You can type these names into the **Key** and **Hotkey** fields. Capital letters are treated like small letters.

Keys	Names
Letters, digits, signs	`a` … `z`, `0` … `9`, `,` `.` `-` and so on
Function keys	`f1` … `f12` (up to `f20`)
Common keys	`space`, `enter`, `tab`, `esc`, `backspace`, `delete`, `insert`
Arrows and navigation	`up`, `down`, `left`, `right`, `home`, `end`, `page_up`, `page_down`
Modifier keys	`shift`, `ctrl`, `alt`, `cmd` (the Windows key), `caps_lock`
Other names that work	`spacebar`, `return`, `escape`, `control`, `del`, `pgup`, `pgdn`, `win`, `capslock`
Any key by code	`vk` and the Windows virtual-key number, for example `vk96` for the number pad key 0

The easiest way is always the **Record** button: click it and press the key.

Addendum (version 1.6) – Settings tab and animations

> **Note:** Figures 6 and 7 in this guide show the earlier layout. In version 1.6 the theme buttons moved from the main page to the new **Settings** tab, and the **Key** card shows an on-screen key. All other controls work as described in the guide.

The program now has two tabs at the top: **Autoclicker** (everything described in Step 6) and **Settings**. Click a tab to switch. The line under the tabs slides to the active tab.

Settings tab

- **Appearance:** choose **System**, **Light** or **Dark**. **System** follows the Windows setting. The checkbox **Animations** switches all animations on or off.
- **Accent color:** the color of selected buttons, the Start button, checkmarks and the tab line. Click one of the round color chips (the first chip is the theme default), type a hex code such as `#e11d48` and press **Enter**, or click **Pick…** to open the Windows color chooser.
- **Colors:** change the **Background**, the **Cards** and the **Text** color by clicking a chip and choosing a color. The colors are saved separately for the light and the dark theme, and the card title shows which theme you are editing. **Reset colors** restores the default colors of the current theme.
- **Startup: Start with Windows (minimized)**, as described in the guide.

If you pick text and background colors that are hard to read, click **Reset colors**.

Animations

- The **Key** card shows an on-screen key. In **Click** mode it is pressed down and flashes in the accent color every time the program presses your key. In **Hold key** mode it stays pressed while the key is held and pops up when the key is released.
- Buttons, switches and checkboxes fade smoothly when you point at them, click them or change their state. The **Start** button fades to red and back.
- Turn **Animations** off in the Settings tab if you prefer a static window or want the lowest CPU use.

The program does not log what you type. It only watches for your hotkey and for the key you record.

Addendum (version 1.7) – Window size and compact view

Resize the window

- Drag any edge or corner of the window to make it larger or smaller. You can also maximize it.
- When the window is too small for its content, a thin scrollbar appears on the right. Scroll with the mouse wheel or drag the scrollbar.
- The **Start / Stop** button and the status line always stay visible at the bottom, however small the window is.
- The program remembers the size and position of the window for the next start. If the saved position is no longer on the screen (for example after unplugging a monitor), the window opens at the default position.

Size (scaling)

- In the **Settings** tab, card **Window**, choose **80%**, **90%**, **100%**, **125%** or **150%**. Text, buttons and the on-screen key grow or shrink together, and the window adjusts to the new size.
- Shortcuts while the program window is active: `Ctrl` + `+` larger, `Ctrl` + `−` smaller, `Ctrl` + `0` back to 100 %. `Ctrl` + mouse wheel works too.
- You can change the size while the autoclicker runs. It keeps running.

Compact view

- Click **Compact** at the top right, or tick **Compact view** in the Settings tab. The window shrinks to a small panel with the on-screen key, a one-line summary (for example *Click · SPACE · every 100 ms*) and the Start / Stop button.
- Click **Expand** to return to the full window in its previous size.
- The program also remembers the compact view for the next start.

Always on top

Tick **Always on top** in the Window card to keep the program in front of other windows. This works well together with the compact view.

Addendum (version 1.8) – Combinations, countdown, time limit, emergency stop

Key combinations

- The **Key** and the **Start/Stop hotkey** can now be a combination. Join the keys with `+`, for example `ctrl+c`, `shift+tab`, `ctrl+shift+s` or `alt+f4`. Modifier keys are `ctrl`, `alt`, `shift` and `win`; they always come before the last key.
- Easiest: click **Record** and press the whole combination (hold `Ctrl`, press `C`). To record a modifier on its own, press and release it, for example `Shift`.
- The program presses the modifiers first and the last key after them, and releases them in reverse order. In **Hold key** mode the whole combination is held.
- The hotkey must not be part of the key combination (for example key `ctrl+f6` with hotkey `f6`); the program tells you if this happens.
- A single hotkey such as `F6` still works while you hold Shift or Ctrl.

Timing & safety card

- **Start delay (sec)**: after you start, the status line counts down (*Starting in 3 …*). Use the time to click into the target window. Pressing the hotkey or **Stop** during the countdown cancels the start. **0** starts immediately. The default is 3 seconds (maximum 60).
- **Stop after (min, 0 = never)**: stops automatically after this many minutes. Decimals work, for example `0.5` for 30 seconds. In **Hold key** mode the key is released when the time is up.
- Under the status line you see the number of key presses and the running time of the current run.

Emergency stop

- **Emergency stop with Esc**: pressing `Esc` stops the program at once and releases every key. This is switched off automatically while Esc is itself the key being pressed.
- **Emergency stop: mouse into a screen corner**: push the mouse pointer into any corner of the screen to stop at once.
- Both options are on by default and can be switched off in the **Timing & safety** card.

> If you start the program while the mouse pointer is already in a screen corner, the corner emergency stop ends the run immediately. Move the mouse away from the corner first.

Addendum (version 1.9) – Transparent background, background image, opacity

Open the **Settings** tab. The new card **Background** has three choices: **Color**, **Transparent** and **Image**.

Color

The normal background with the colors from the **Colors** card.

Transparent (Windows only)

- The window background between the cards becomes see-through. You see your desktop or other windows behind it; the cards, buttons and texts stay visible.
- Clicks on the see-through parts go to the window behind. Move the program by its title bar.
- Thin colored edges can appear around texts that are directly on the see-through background. This is normal for this Windows feature.

Image

- Click **Image** or **Choose image…** and pick a picture (PNG, JPG, BMP, GIF or WEBP). The program keeps its own copy in `%APPDATA%\KeyboardAutoclicker\background.png`, so you can move or delete the original.
- The picture fills the window and is cropped at the edges if needed. It moves with the content when you scroll and adapts when you resize the window.
- **Image strength** (25–100 %) mixes the picture with the background color so that text stays readable. 100 % shows the picture unchanged.
- **Remove image** deletes the program's copy and switches back to **Color**.

Window opacity

Makes the *whole* window see-through, including text and buttons: 100 % (normal) down to 60 %. It works together with all three background choices.

> The pictures need the Pillow package. It is included in the EXE and the installer. If you start the program as a Python file, run `pip install pillow` once.